



PHISHING AWARENESS TRAINING

Protecting Yourself from Online Scams

CodeAlpha Cyber Security Internship

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What is Phishing?

- Phishing is a cyber attack where attackers try to trick people into revealing sensitive information.
- They create fake emails, messages, or websites that look real and trustworthy.
- Main goal is to steal:
 - Login credentials (username & password)
 - Bank account details and credit card information
 - OTP and one-time passwords
- It is one of the most common and successful cyber attacks worldwide.

Phishing is a form of social engineering — it attacks human trust, not just technology.

Why Do People Fall for Phishing?

People become victims because of common human emotions and habits:

Fear	Urgency	Greed	Trust
"Your account will be blocked" creates panic	"Act within 24 hours" forces quick decisions	"You have won a big prize" tempts people	Email looks like it is from a real company

- **Lack of awareness** — Many people do not know the warning signs.

Most victims do not carefully check the sender address or the actual link.

Common Types of Phishing Attacks

- **1. Email Phishing** — Fake emails sent to a large number of people
- **2. Spear Phishing** — Targeted attack on a specific person using personal details
- **3. Whaling** — Attack aimed at high-level executives (CEO, managers)
- **4. Smishing** — Phishing through SMS / text messages
- **5. Vishing** — Phishing through phone calls (voice phishing)
- **6. Clone Phishing** — Copy of a legitimate email with malicious links added

Attackers continuously invent new methods, so awareness is very important.



How to Identify Phishing Emails

Watch out for these common warning signs (red flags):

- Email creates a strong sense of urgency or fear
- Sender's email address looks strange or slightly different
- Poor spelling, grammar mistakes, or awkward language
- Unexpected attachments or suspicious links
- Asking for password, OTP, PIN, or personal details
- Generic greeting such as "Dear Customer" instead of your real name



Tip: Always hover your mouse over any link to see the real website address before clicking.



How to Identify Fake Websites

- Check the website URL very carefully before entering any information
- Look for **https://** and a padlock icon in the address bar
- Domain name is slightly changed (example: paypa1.com instead of paypal.com)
- Website design looks low quality, different, or unprofessional
- Too many pop-ups or strange requests for extra personal information
- Asking for details that the real website normally does not request

Even a small difference in the domain name can mean the website is fake.

Social Engineering Tactics Used by Attackers

Attackers manipulate human emotions and psychology:

- **Authority** — Pretend to be from bank, police, government, or company support
- **Urgency** — Force you to act quickly without thinking or verifying
- **Fear** — Threaten that something bad will happen if you do not respond
- **Greed** — Offer money, prizes, free gifts, or exclusive deals
- **Helpfulness** — Act like they are trying to help you solve a problem

They study human psychology to make the scam more believable and successful.

Real-World Examples

- 1. Fake bank emails asking to update KYC or reactivate your account
- 2. Fake courier / delivery messages (Amazon, Flipkart, Bluedart style)
- 3. Fake job offers that ask for registration or processing fees
- 4. Fake “You have won a lottery / prize” messages and emails
- 5. COVID-19, government scheme, or tax-related phishing scams

These types of attacks are very common in India, Pakistan, and many other countries.



Best Practices to Stay Safe

- Never click on suspicious links or download unknown attachments
- Do not share OTP, password, or PIN with anyone — even if they claim to be from the bank
- Always verify the sender through the official website or mobile app
- Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) on all important accounts
- Use strong and unique passwords for every account
- Keep your phone, laptop, browser, and antivirus updated
- When in doubt, directly call or visit the official website — do not use links from the message

Remember: Real banks and companies never ask for OTP or password through email or SMS.

? Interactive Quiz

Q1. An email says: “Your account will be blocked in 12 hours. Click here to verify.” Is this safe?

A) Yes B) No

Q2. You get an SMS: “Your parcel is held at customs. Pay ■2 to release.” What should you do?

A) Pay immediately B) Ignore and check from the official app

Q3. Email address is support@amaz0n.com (with zero). Is this legitimate?

A) Yes B) No

Answers: 1-B 2-B 3-B



Key Takeaways

- Always think before you click on any link or attachment
- Verify the source before trusting any email, SMS, or call
- Never share sensitive information (OTP, password, PIN) through email or SMS
- Awareness and caution are your best protection against phishing
- One small mistake can lead to big financial loss or identity theft

Stay alert. Stay safe. Stay informed.



THANK YOU!

Stay Alert. Stay Safe.

Any Questions?

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